

OREGON STATE HOSPITAL

POLICY

SECTION 6: Patient Care **POLICY: 6.060**

SUBJECT: Photographs for Patient Identification

POINT PERSON: Director of Security

APPROVED: Sara Walker, MD  **DATE: NOVEMBER 15, 2024**
Interim Superintendent

SELECT ONE: ☐ New policy ☐ Minor/technical revision of existing policy
☒ Reaffirmation of existing policy ☐ Major revision of existing policy

I. PURPOSE AND APPLICABILITY

- A. Patient photographs taken by Oregon State Hospital (OSH) security staff are used for patient identification by staff for the accurate and safe delivery of treatment and services. Patient photographs are subject to applicable confidentiality laws.
- B. This policy applies to staff authorized to take photos of patients for patient identification purposes

II. POLICY

- A. A photograph must be taken of a patient:
 - 1. within 24 hours of admission;
 - 2. annually, if necessary;
 - 3. within 24 hours of an inter-campus transfer between the Salem and Junction City campuses, with exception of a temporary transfer to the medical unit. The receiving campus will complete the patient photograph process upon arrival of the patient;
 - 4. if an identification badge, or Avatar has poor photograph quality; and
 - 5. whenever a patient's appearance changes to the extent staff may be unable to identify the patient easily or accurately by the photograph, including, but not limited to, significant changes in hair color or style, facial hair, facial tattoos, weight, eyeglasses, dentition, or general facial appearance.

- B. A photograph does not need to be repeated if taken within the previous month of one of the situations noted above and there is no significant change in the patient's appearance.
- C. The camera and photograph settings must align to the following guidelines:
 - 1. minimum resolution dimensions must be at least 600 x 600 pixels;
 - 2. aspect ratio must be 1:1;
 - 3. the camera must be positioned more than four feet from the patient;
 - 4. the patient's upper body and space above the patient's head must be included in the viewfinder;
 - 5. the background must be well-lit or off-white and free of patterns, objects, textures, etc.;
 - 6. shadows caused by overhead lighting must be eliminated or minimized;
 - 7. distance between subject and background must be minimized.
- D. Admissions, Nursing Services and Security must follow Procedures A, "Patient Photograph Process" during the admission process or when requesting a new patient photograph.
- E. This policy applies to all staff, including employees, volunteers, trainees, interns, contractors, vendors, and other state employees assigned to work at OSH. Staff who fail to comply with this policy or related procedures may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal.
- F. OSH follows all applicable regulations, including federal and state statutes and rules; Oregon Department of Administrative Services (DAS), Shared Services, and Oregon Health Authority (OHA) policies; and relevant accreditation standards. Such regulations supersede the provisions of this policy unless this policy is more restrictive.
- G. Staff who fail to comply with this policy or related policy attachments or protocols may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal.

III. DEFINITIONS

"Staff" includes employees, volunteers, trainees, interns, contractors, vendors, and other state employees assigned to work at Oregon State Hospital (OSH).

IV. PROCEDURES

Procedures A Patient Photograph Process

V. RELATED OSH POLICIES AND PROTOCOLS

2.018 Complete Medical Record
7.003 Photographing or Recording of Patients
8.007 Identification Badges

VI. REFERENCES

Joint Commission Resources, Inc. (2024). *The joint commission comprehensive accreditation manual for hospitals*, NPSG.01.01.01. Oakbrook Terrace, IL: Author.

Bureau of Consular Affairs, U.S. Department of State. *Photographers guide*. Retrieved from <https://travel.state.gov/content/passports/en/passports/photos/photographers-guide.html>